# Basic ICT Productivity Tools

Formal communication tools and etiquette

# 1. Formal Communication Tools

- Formal communication tools are designed to support professional and structured exchanges within organizations or between businesses. Two of the most commonly used platforms are **Gmail** and **Microsoft Outlook**. These platforms offer a range of features that enhance communication and productivity in the workplace.

# 1.1 Gmail

Gmail, developed by Google, is a widely used email service that integrates seamlessly with Google Workspace. It is suitable for personal use, business communication, and collaborations.

**Key Features:**

- **Email Management:** Filters, labels, and folders help in organizing emails.
- **Integration with Google Services:** Seamless connection with Google Calendar, Google Drive, Google Meet, and more.
- **Search Functionality:** Advanced search options to easily find emails.
- **Security:** Built-in spam filtering, encryption, and two-factor authentication (2FA) for added security.


Google
Google
Gmail
Maps

# 1.2 Microsoft Outlook

Microsoft Outlook, part of the Microsoft Office suite, is a powerful email client with robust features suitable for businesses and individuals.

**Key Features:**

- **Calendar Integration:** Combines scheduling and email functionalities for easier meeting management.
- **Task Management:** Allows users to create tasks and set reminders.
- **Folder Management:** Organize emails with folders, categories, and rules.
- **Offline Access:** Users can manage emails offline, and changes sync when back online.


2:05
Outlook
Microsoft Outlook
Secure Email, Calendar
& Files
UPDATE
AGE
4+
Years Old

# 2. Email Etiquette

- When using formal communication tools like Gmail or Outlook, maintaining professionalism is essential. The tone, structure, and content of an email reflect your professionalism and can influence the perception of both sender and receiver. Here are key etiquette guidelines to follow:

1. **Subject Line**

- **Keep it Clear and Concise:** Ensure the subject line accurately reflects the email's content. This helps recipients prioritize the email.
  - Example: "Meeting Rescheduled: New Date and Time"

2. **Greeting and Salutation**

- **Formal Greetings:** Use professional salutations like "Dear" or "Hello" followed by the recipient's name.
  - Example: "Dear Dr. Smith," or "Hello Mr. Johnson,"
- **Closing Salutations:** Use courteous phrases such as "Best regards," "Sincerely," or "Kind regards" to end the email.

3. **Structure of the Email**

- **Introduction:** Briefly introduce the purpose of your email.
  - Example: "I hope this email finds you well. I am writing to confirm our meeting scheduled for..."
- **Body:** Present information clearly and concisely, ensuring your points are well-structured. Use paragraphs to break up content for easier readability.
- **Conclusion:** Sum up the main point of the email and indicate any follow-up actions, if necessary.
  - Example: "Please let me know if you need any further information regarding this matter."

4. **Language and Tone**

- **Professional Language:** Avoid slang, emoticons, or overly casual language in formal emails.
  - Example: Use "Please advise" instead of "Let me know."
- **Politeness:** Always be polite, even when addressing problems or concerns.
  - Example: "Could you please clarify..." instead of "I don't understand."

5. **Proofreading**

- **Check for Errors:** Always proofread for spelling, grammar, and punctuation errors. A well-written email reflects your attention to detail.
  - Example: Ensure that "you're" is correctly used instead of "your."

6. **Signature**

- **Professional Signature:** Include a formal email signature with your full name, title, and contact information.
  - Example:

Best regards,

Jane Doe

Project Manager

ABC Corporation

jane.doe@abc.com

(123) 456-7890

7. **Attachments**

- **Attach Files Before Composing:** If sending attachments, remember to attach the files before writing your message to avoid sending emails without them.
- **Describe Attachments:** Mention in the email body that files are attached and provide a brief description.
  - Example: "Please find the project proposal attached for your review."

# 3. Calendar and Scheduling Features

- Both Gmail (Google Calendar) and Outlook offer calendar features that simplify scheduling and organizing meetings.

**1. Scheduling Meetings (Microsoft Outlook)**

- Use the "New Meeting" feature to schedule meetings and invite attendees.
- Attach files and link to online meeting platforms like Microsoft Teams.
- Set meeting reminders and sync with attendees' calendars.

**2. Google Calendar (Gmail)**

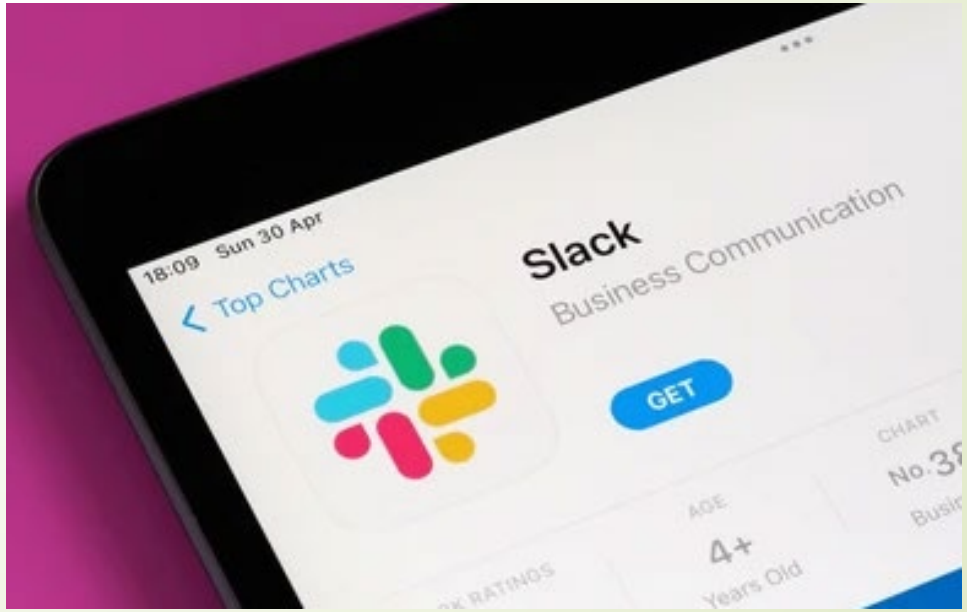
- Create events directly from emails in Gmail.
- Invite others to events and attach documents.
- Set up Google Meet links for virtual meetings.

# Other Formal Communication Tools

- While Gmail and Outlook are popular, there are other tools that support formal communication in professional environments.

**1. Slack**

- A messaging platform that facilitates instant communication within teams.
- Allows for channel-based organization, which can be segmented by projects or departments.



# Other Formal Communication Tools

**2. Microsoft Teams**

- Integrates with Outlook and offers chat, video conferencing, and collaboration tools in one platform.
- Effective for both formal and informal communication.



# Task II

- Create your email account on gmail and write down the process in steps

# Task III

- Install an app named Slack
- Add your project team
- Use it for all kind of project communication and keep the record
- Paste the screenshots in task III